

Description:

Red opaque/Blue opaque size 0 capsule, filled with white to yellowish powder

Content:

Each capsule contains:

Crystalline Glucosamine Sulphate 314mg equivalent to Glucosamine Sulphate 250mg
Chondroitin Sulphate Sodium 220mg equivalent to Chondroitin Sulphate 200mg

Indication:

As adjuvant therapy for osteoarthritis

Pharmacodynamics:

Glucosamine is an aminomonosaccharide, particularly in the management of all forms of degenerative osteoarticular diseases e.g. arthrosis and osteoarthritis, both subacute and chronic, with disappearance or reduction of articular pains, improvement of articular functions and inhibition or regression of the degeneration process. Glucosamine possesses arthrotropic metabolic activity by stimulating the anabolic metabolism of osteocartilaginous tissues, through the stimulation of the biosynthesis of the mucopolysaccharides (which are essential components of the cartilage substances) and of the bone mesenchymal tissues. Lubricant activities are through improvement of synovial fluid viscosity by increasing synovial fluid production. Chondroitin sulphate, a glycoaminoglycan, is utilised by chondrocytes which is found in the articular matrix, to produce new collagen and proteoglycans.

Pharmacokinetics:

After oral administration of glucosamine, only 26% is absorbed with onset of action about 2-3 weeks for osteoarthritis. Bioavailability is low due to first pass hepatic metabolism. Following oral administration, glucosamine is extensively metabolised in the liver. It is rapidly desulfated and metabolised

into smaller molecules, and ultimately to carbon dioxide, water and urea. Glucosamine is not protein-bound, but rather incorporates into the plasma proteins (primarily globulin). Rapid diffusion into most tissues also occurs, including articular tissues. Urinary excretion accounts for 10% of an oral dose, about 11% is eliminated via the faeces, presumably as an unabsorbed drug. The elimination half-life of glucosamine which is incorporated into the plasma proteins is about 68 hours after oral doses. Part of a dose of glucosamine sulphate is eliminated as carbon dioxide via expired air in the lungs. Chondroitin sulphate shows first order kinetics up to single doses of 3,000mg. Multiple doses of 800mg in patients with osteoarthritis do not alter the kinetics of chondroitin sulphate. The bioavailability of chondroitin sulphate ranges from 15% to 24% of the orally administered dose. More particularly, on the articular tissue, chondroitin sulphate is rapidly absorbed in the gastro-intestinal tract and a high content of labeled chondroitin sulphate is found in synovial fluid and cartilage.

Adverse effects:

Cardiovascular: Peripheral oedema, tachycardia were reported in a few patients following a larger clinical trial investigating oral administration in osteoarthritis. Causal relationship has not been established.

Central nervous system: Drowsiness, headache, insomnia have been observed rarely during therapy (less than 1%).

Gastrointestinal: Nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea, dyspepsia or epigastric pain, constipation, heartburn and anorexia have been described rarely during oral therapy of osteoarthritis.

Skin: Skin reactions such as erythema and pruritis have been rare complications.

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Warning and precautions: Glucosamine sulphate is a causal therapy and the therapeutic effect is only seen after 1 week. Therefore, it is advisable to include an antiinflammatory drug (in case of severe pains) during the first days of treatment with glucosamine. Derived from seafood.

Interactions with other medicaments: Consult your physician if you are on any medication. Chitosan may form complex with chondroitin sulphate, decreasing its absorption. Therefore, do not use concomitantly with chitosan. The use of glucosamine with oral hypoglycemic agent (metformin, tolbutamide, rosiglitazone) may reduce oral hypoglycaemic agent effectiveness.

Contraindications: It is contraindicated in patients hypersensitive to glucosamine sulphate or chondroitin sulphate. Contraindicated in patients allergic to shellfish.

Pregnancy and lactation: Avoid usage in children, pregnant women and nursing mothers.

Symptoms and treatment of overdose: Glucosamine sulphate and chondroitin sulphate are well tolerated following an oral dose and no signs and symptoms of toxicity have been reported. In case of an accidental overdose, seek professional assistance or contact a poison centre immediately.

Dosage and administration:

Light to moderate symptoms

- 2 capsules twice daily before meals for at least 6 weeks

Severe symptoms

- 2 capsules three times daily before meals

Storage: Store in a dry place at temperature below 30°C. Protect from light. Keep out of reach of children.

Pack size: Blister pack – 30's, 50's, 60's, 100's, 120's, 150's, 180's
Bottle pack – 30's, 50's, 60's, 100's, 120's, 150's, 180's

Shelf life: 3 years

Product registration holder: Medipharma Industries Sdn Bhd
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